

Understanding class definitions

Exploring source code



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Main concepts to be covered

- fields
- constructors
- methods
- parameters
- assignment statements

Ticket machine Example

- This is a very simple Ticket machine.
- It prints a ticket when an amount of money is entered



Ticket machines – an external view

- Exploring the behavior of a typical ticket machine.
 - Use the *naive-ticket-machine* project.
 - Machines supply tickets of a fixed price.
 - How is that price determined?
 - How is ‘money’ ‘entered’ into a machine?
 - How does a machine keep track of the money that is entered?



Ticket machine Example

What
information do
we need to
store?



What can the
Ticket Machine
do?

Ticket machine Example

What information do we need to store?

- Price of ticket
- Amount entered
- Amount in machine
- ...



What can the Ticket Machine do?

- Accept Payment
- Print Ticket
- ...

Ticket machine Example

What **fields**
information do
we need to
store?

- Price of ticket
- Number of tickets sold
- Amount in machine
- ?



methods
What can the
Ticket Machine
do?

- Accept Payment
- Print Ticket
- ?

Ticket machines – an internal view

- Interacting with an object gives us clues about its behavior.
- Looking inside allows us to determine how that behavior is provided or implemented.
- All Java classes have a similar-looking internal view.

Basic class structure

```
public class TicketMachine  
{  
    Inner part omitted.  
}
```

The outer wrapper
of TicketMachine

The diagram consists of two callout boxes with arrows pointing to specific parts of the code. The first callout box, labeled 'The outer wrapper of TicketMachine', has an arrow pointing to the 'public class TicketMachine' line. The second callout box, labeled 'The inner contents of a class', has an arrow pointing to the 'Fields', 'Constructors', and 'Methods' lines within the class body.

```
public class ClassName  
{  
    Fields  
    Constructors  
    Methods  
}
```

The inner
contents of a
class

Keywords

- Words with a special meaning in the language:
 - `public`
 - `class`
 - `private`
 - `int`
- Also known as *reserved words*.
- Always entirely lower-case.

Fields

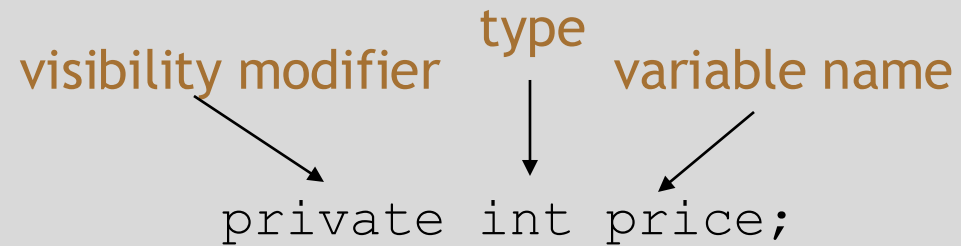
- Fields store values for an object.
- They are also known as *instance variables*.
- Fields define the state of an object.
- Use *Inspect* to view the state.
- Some values change often.
- Some change rarely (or not at all).

```
public class TicketMachine
{
    private int price;
    private int balance;
    private int total;

    //Further details omitted.
}
```

visibility modifier type variable name

private int price;

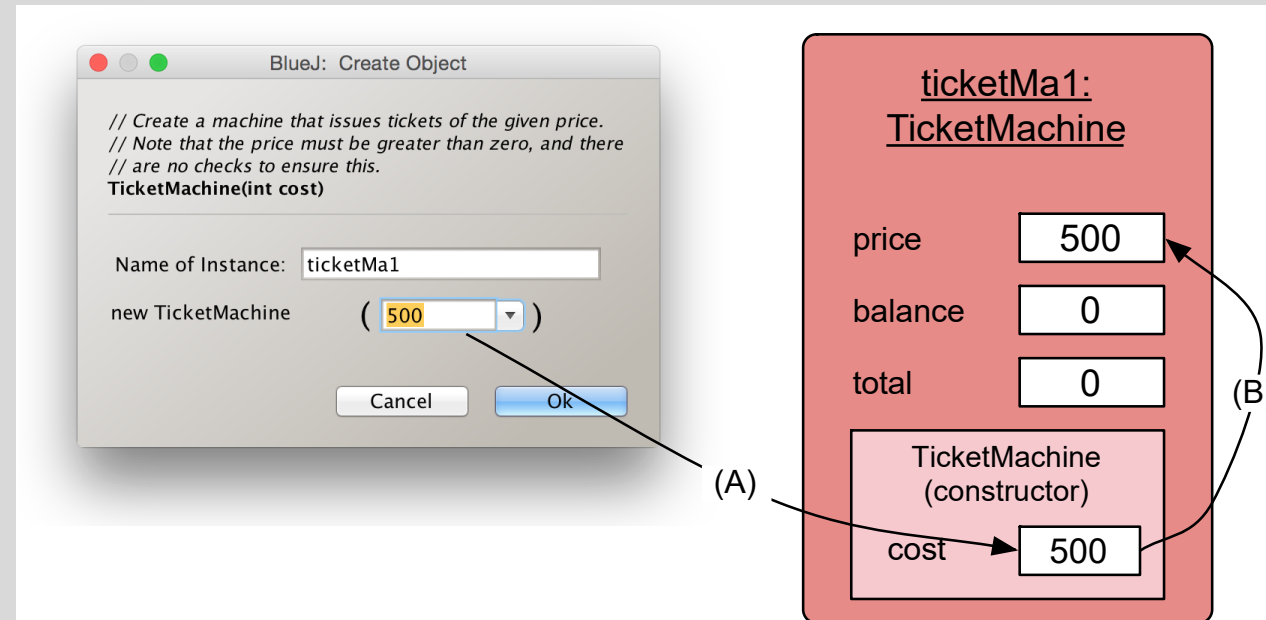


Constructors

- Initialise an object.
- Have the same name as their class.
- Close association with the fields:
 - Initial values stored into the fields.
 - Parameter values often used for these.

```
public TicketMachine(int cost)
{
    price = cost;
    balance = 0;
    total = 0;
}
```

Passing data via parameters



Parameters are another sort of variable.

Variables

In Programming, variables:

- are created (defined) in your programs
- are used to store data (whose value can change over time)
- have a data type
- have a name
- are a VERY important programming concept

Assignment

- Values are stored into fields (and other variables) via assignment statements:

– *variable = expression;*



pattern

– **balance = balance + amount;**



example

- A variable can store just one value, so any previous value is lost.
- Assignment statements work by taking the value of what appears on the right-hand side of the operator and copying that value into a variable on the left-hand side.

Next concepts to be covered

- Methods, including:
 - *accessor* (*getter*) methods
 - *mutator* (*setter*) methods;
- String formatting;
- Conditional statements;
- Local variables.

Questions?

